Skill 13

Consider Alternative Explanations

What Else Could Explain It?

160 Items	**1-5** Levels	**Pick another explanation that also fits the facts.** Objective

Essential question. What else could explain the same facts?

This PDF is designed for classroom use. It gives teachers a rigorous introduction to the skill, a repeatable solving routine, likely student confusions, a worked example, and the full XiXteen item set with choice-level feedback.

Generated from the current XiXteen corpus on 2026-10-29.

Skill 13

Consider Alternative Explanations

What Else Could Explain It?

Pick another explanation that also fits the facts. Objective	**160** Items	**Levels 1-5** Difficulty bands

Essential question	What else could explain the same facts?
Why it matters	Good thinkers do not stop at the first explanation that fits. They ask what else could make the same facts true, especially when a conclusion is attractive.
Conceptual core	Alternative explanation thinking is disciplined imagination. Students keep the observed evidence fixed and ask what other story could make it true. This reduces premature closure, especially when the first explanation is emotionally satisfying or easy to remember. The strongest alternative explanation is specific, plausible, and compatible with the given facts.
Student method	Keep the observed facts fixed, then generate another story that could produce them. The best alternative is specific and fits the evidence without contradicting it.
Analogy	Alternative explanations are spare keys. If more than one key opens the same lock, you should not assume you have found the only one.
Assessment focus	A good answer names a plausible alternative that matches the observed facts and avoids unsupported contradictions.

Teaching Sequence

1. Name the observed result without interpreting it.

2. Generate another cause, condition, or selection effect that could produce the same result.

3. Reject alternatives that contradict the prompt.

4. Prefer alternatives that are specific enough to test.

Common Confusions To Watch For

1. Students may offer a random possibility that does not fit the facts.

2. Students may think an alternative explanation must disprove the original explanation.

3. Students may choose a vague phrase like many factors without naming one.

Teacher Prompts

1. What fact are we trying to explain?

2. What other story could make that fact true?

3. How could we test the original explanation against this alternative?

Worked Example

Scenario	A museum's family attendance rises after free Friday admission begins, but a popular dinosaur exhibit opens the same weekend.
Teacher think-aloud	Free admission could matter, but the new exhibit could also explain the attendance increase. Both fit the observed rise, so we need more evidence to separate them.
Student takeaway	An alternative explanation does not have to be proven; it has to plausibly fit the same evidence.

Guided Classroom Exercise

Invented case. Use only the facts below; write on paper. Try the steps and check your work before reading the model answer. Different wording can be equally adequate.

Situation. A museum's family visits rise from 200 to 320 during the first weekend of free admission. That weekend also brings a new dinosaur exhibit, a school holiday, and unusually heavy rain. The museum credits free admission alone.

What To Do

1. List three rival explanations using the supplied details.

2. For each, write one sentence explaining how it could increase museum visits. Mark these as possibilities, not established causes.

3. Choose one rival and name a comparison that would help distinguish it from the effect of price.

Check before reading the answer. Have you explained a plausible connection for each rival instead of merely listing coinciding events?

Model Answer

The dinosaur exhibit might attract interested families; the holiday might give them more free time; rain might make indoor activities more attractive. To examine the exhibit explanation, compare similar weekends with the same exhibit but different admission prices while keeping holiday and weather conditions as comparable as possible. The supplied facts do not tell us which cause contributed how much.

Why it is adequate. It supplies mechanisms for three alternatives and a relevant follow-up comparison without presenting possibilities as findings.

Item Bank

Items are grouped by level. For each item, read the prompt, predict the answer, choose, and then use the feedback and process commentary to examine the reasoning path.

Level 1

Level 1 establishes the clean version of the skill: the cue is direct, the distractors are visible, and the main task is to learn the contrast.

alternative_explanations-001 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The city council tried extending evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** A large employer started a private shuttle the same month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, transportation, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-002 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The school board tried requiring phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-003 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The hospital tried sending medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** Pharmacists also began follow-up calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-004 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The company tried testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The company also raised salaries that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-005 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The grocery chain tried adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, retail, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-006 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The library tried waiving late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The library also opened on Sundays; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public services, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-007 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The platform tried requiring two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-008 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. Police patrols increased during the same period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public safety, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-009 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The university tried expanding peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The final exam was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-010 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The restaurant group tried showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Dessert prices increased at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nutrition, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-011 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The bank tried sending overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The bank also changed its fee grace period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, finance, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-012 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The park service tried using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** A nearby trail reopened that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-013 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The museum tried offering free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A new children's exhibit opened the same week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, culture, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-014 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The sports league tried adding mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The league also shortened the season; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, sports, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-015 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The nonprofit tried sending donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nonprofit, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-016 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The warehouse tried offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. New lifting equipment arrived that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace safety, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-017 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried placing compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Trash pickup schedules also changed; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-018 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The app maker tried making new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The app also deleted inactive accounts; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-019 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The clinic tried reserving same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The clinic also began reminder calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The appointment cards are white. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-020 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The airline tried boarding passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The airline also reduced carry-on size limits; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, travel, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-021 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The landlord tried launching an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The landlord hired two additional repair technicians; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, housing, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-022 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The cafeteria tried moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** A fruit discount started that week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, food, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-023 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The call center tried giving support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The call queue was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, customer support, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-024 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The water utility tried sending automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. A rainy season began during the study; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, utilities, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-025 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The police department tried sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The department also updated supervisor reviews; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, governance, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-026 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The election office tried offering online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The office also expanded its phone staff; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, election administration, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-027 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The tutoring app tried sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The app also changed the quiz format; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, learning, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-028 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The gym tried offering a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The gym also discounted annual plans; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, fitness, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-029 | Level 1 | Answer D

Prompt. The insurer tried sending weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, insurance, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-030 | Level 1 | Answer C

Prompt. The newsroom tried placing corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The newsroom also hired a public editor; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, media, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-031 | Level 1 | Answer A

Prompt. The farmers market tried requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The market also added a weekend help desk; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, local commerce, d1

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-032 | Level 1 | Answer B

Prompt. The hotel tried sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The hotel also changed room assignments; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, hospitality, d1

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

Level 2

Level 2 keeps the same skill but adds more realistic wording and more tempting distractors.

alternative_explanations-033 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The city council tried extending evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A large employer started a private shuttle the same month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, transportation, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-034 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The school board tried requiring phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-035 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The hospital tried sending medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. Pharmacists also began follow-up calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-036 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The company tried testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The company also raised salaries that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-037 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The grocery chain tried adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, retail, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-038 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The library tried waiving late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The library also opened on Sundays; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public services, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-039 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The platform tried requiring two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-040 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** Police patrols increased during the same period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public safety, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-041 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The university tried expanding peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The final exam was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-042 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The restaurant group tried showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** Dessert prices increased at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nutrition, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-043 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The bank tried sending overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The bank also changed its fee grace period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, finance, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-044 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The park service tried using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A nearby trail reopened that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-045 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The museum tried offering free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** A new children's exhibit opened the same week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, culture, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-046 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The sports league tried adding mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The league also shortened the season; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, sports, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-047 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The nonprofit tried sending donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nonprofit, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-048 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The warehouse tried offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. New lifting equipment arrived that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace safety, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-049 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried placing compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** Trash pickup schedules also changed; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-050 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The app maker tried making new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The app also deleted inactive accounts; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-051 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The clinic tried reserving same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The appointment cards are white. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The clinic also began reminder calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-052 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The airline tried boarding passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The airline also reduced carry-on size limits; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, travel, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-053 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The landlord tried launching an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The landlord hired two additional repair technicians; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, housing, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-054 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The cafeteria tried moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** A fruit discount started that week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, food, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-055 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The call center tried giving support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The call queue was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, customer support, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-056 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The water utility tried sending automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** A rainy season began during the study; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, utilities, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-057 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The police department tried sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The department also updated supervisor reviews; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, governance, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-058 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The election office tried offering online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The office also expanded its phone staff; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, election administration, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-059 | Level 2 | Answer C

Prompt. The tutoring app tried sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The app also changed the quiz format; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, learning, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-060 | Level 2 | Answer D

Prompt. The gym tried offering a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The gym also discounted annual plans; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, fitness, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-061 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The insurer tried sending weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, insurance, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-062 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The newsroom tried placing corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The newsroom also hired a public editor; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, media, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-063 | Level 2 | Answer B

Prompt. The farmers market tried requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The market also added a weekend help desk; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, local commerce, d2

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-064 | Level 2 | Answer A

Prompt. The hotel tried sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The hotel also changed room assignments; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, hospitality, d2

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

Level 3

Level 3 asks for steadier discrimination: the right answer is still objective, but the wrong answers often sound plausible.

alternative_explanations-065 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The city council tried extending evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** A large employer started a private shuttle the same month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, transportation, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-066 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The school board tried requiring phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-067 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The hospital tried sending medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** Pharmacists also began follow-up calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-068 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The company tried testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The company also raised salaries that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-069 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The grocery chain tried adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, retail, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-070 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The library tried waiving late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The library also opened on Sundays; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public services, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-071 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The platform tried requiring two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-072 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. Police patrols increased during the same period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public safety, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-073 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The university tried expanding peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The final exam was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-074 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The restaurant group tried showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Dessert prices increased at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nutrition, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-075 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The bank tried sending overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The bank also changed its fee grace period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, finance, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-076 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The park service tried using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** A nearby trail reopened that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-077 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The museum tried offering free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A new children's exhibit opened the same week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, culture, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-078 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The sports league tried adding mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The league also shortened the season; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, sports, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-079 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The nonprofit tried sending donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nonprofit, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-080 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The warehouse tried offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** New lifting equipment arrived that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace safety, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-081 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried placing compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Trash pickup schedules also changed; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-082 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The app maker tried making new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The app also deleted inactive accounts; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-083 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The clinic tried reserving same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The appointment cards are white. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The clinic also began reminder calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-084 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The airline tried boarding passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The airline also reduced carry-on size limits; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, travel, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-085 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The landlord tried launching an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The landlord hired two additional repair technicians; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, housing, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-086 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The cafeteria tried moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. A fruit discount started that week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, food, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-087 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The call center tried giving support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The call queue was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, customer support, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-088 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The water utility tried sending automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A rainy season began during the study; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, utilities, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-089 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The police department tried sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The department also updated supervisor reviews; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, governance, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-090 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The election office tried offering online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The office also expanded its phone staff; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, election administration, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-091 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The tutoring app tried sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The app also changed the quiz format; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, learning, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-092 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The gym tried offering a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The gym also discounted annual plans; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, fitness, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-093 | Level 3 | Answer D

Prompt. The insurer tried sending weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, insurance, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-094 | Level 3 | Answer C

Prompt. The newsroom tried placing corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The newsroom also hired a public editor; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, media, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-095 | Level 3 | Answer A

Prompt. The farmers market tried requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The market also added a weekend help desk; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, local commerce, d3

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-096 | Level 3 | Answer B

Prompt. The hotel tried sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The hotel also changed room assignments; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, hospitality, d3

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

Level 4

Level 4 asks learners to hold more context in mind while applying the same method.

alternative_explanations-097 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The city council tried extending evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. A large employer started a private shuttle the same month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, transportation, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-098 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The school board tried requiring phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-099 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The hospital tried sending medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Pharmacists also began follow-up calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-100 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The company tried testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The company also raised salaries that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-101 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The grocery chain tried adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, retail, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-102 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The library tried waiving late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The library also opened on Sundays; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public services, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-103 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The platform tried requiring two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-104 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** Police patrols increased during the same period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public safety, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-105 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The university tried expanding peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The final exam was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-106 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The restaurant group tried showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** Dessert prices increased at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nutrition, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-107 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The bank tried sending overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The bank also changed its fee grace period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, finance, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-108 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The park service tried using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. A nearby trail reopened that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-109 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The museum tried offering free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** A new children's exhibit opened the same week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, culture, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-110 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The sports league tried adding mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The league also shortened the season; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, sports, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-111 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The nonprofit tried sending donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nonprofit, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-112 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The warehouse tried offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. New lifting equipment arrived that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace safety, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-113 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried placing compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** Trash pickup schedules also changed; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-114 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The app maker tried making new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The app also deleted inactive accounts; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-115 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The clinic tried reserving same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The appointment cards are white. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The clinic also began reminder calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-116 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The airline tried boarding passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The airline also reduced carry-on size limits; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, travel, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-117 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The landlord tried launching an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The landlord hired two additional repair technicians; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, housing, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-118 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The cafeteria tried moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** A fruit discount started that week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, food, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-119 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The call center tried giving support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The call queue was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, customer support, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-120 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The water utility tried sending automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** A rainy season began during the study; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, utilities, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-121 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The police department tried sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The department also updated supervisor reviews; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, governance, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-122 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The election office tried offering online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The office also expanded its phone staff; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, election administration, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-123 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The tutoring app tried sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The app also changed the quiz format; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, learning, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-124 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The gym tried offering a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The orientation mats are black. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The gym also discounted annual plans; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, fitness, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-125 | Level 4 | Answer A

Prompt. The insurer tried sending weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, insurance, d4

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-126 | Level 4 | Answer B

Prompt. The newsroom tried placing corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The newsroom also hired a public editor; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, media, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-127 | Level 4 | Answer D

Prompt. The farmers market tried requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The market also added a weekend help desk; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, local commerce, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-128 | Level 4 | Answer C

Prompt. The hotel tried sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The hotel also changed room assignments; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, hospitality, d4

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

Level 5

Level 5 is for fluency: the learner should now name the thinking move and explain the elimination path.

alternative_explanations-129 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The city council tried extending evening bus service until midnight. Late-shift commute complaints fell by 22% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** A large employer started a private shuttle the same month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The new buses were repainted blue. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, transportation, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-130 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The school board tried requiring phone lockers during class. Classroom disruption reports fell by 31% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A new hall monitor schedule began at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The lockers are installed near the gym. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-131 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The hospital tried sending medication reminder texts before evening doses. Missed-dose reports fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The text messages use a green pill icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** Pharmacists also began follow-up calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-132 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The company tried testing a Monday-through-Thursday workweek. Staff resignations fell by 15% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The company also raised salaries that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The test calendar starts on a Monday. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-133 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The grocery chain tried adding larger unit-price labels on shelf tags. Shopper overpayment complaints fell by 27% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** A local consumer group ran a price-literacy campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The shelf labels use bold black numbers. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, retail, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-134 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The library tried waiving late fines for children's books. Library card renewals rose by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The library also opened on Sundays; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The children's-book checkout desk moved six feet. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public services, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-135 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The platform tried requiring two-factor login for site administrators. Admin account takeovers fell by 44% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The login button changed from green to blue. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** Some high-risk admin accounts were removed earlier; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-136 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The neighborhood association tried adding brighter LED streetlights on Maple Street. Reported thefts fell by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The new light poles are made of aluminum. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. Police patrols increased during the same period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, public safety, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-137 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The university tried expanding peer tutoring in statistics. Course pass rates rose by 11% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The tutoring room has new chairs. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The final exam was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, education, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-138 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The restaurant group tried showing calorie labels on printed lunch menus. Dessert orders fell by 16% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The lunch menus are printed on thicker paper. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. Dessert prices increased at the same time; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nutrition, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-139 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The bank tried sending overdraft warning texts before fees post. Overdraft fees fell by 24% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The bank also changed its fee grace period; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The warning texts arrive from a short code. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, finance, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-140 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The park service tried using timed-entry passes for weekend trail visits. Trail crowding complaints fell by 33% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** A nearby trail reopened that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The digital passes include a small trail map. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-141 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The museum tried offering free admission on Fridays. Family visits rose by 29% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The Friday tickets are scanned at the east door. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. A new children's exhibit opened the same week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, culture, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-142 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The sports league tried adding mandatory sideline concussion checks. Repeat head injuries fell by 21% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The concussion checklist is printed on yellow paper. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The league also shortened the season; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, sports, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-143 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The nonprofit tried sending donation receipts within one day. Donor retention rose by 14% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The nonprofit also launched a matching campaign; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The receipt email subject line changed. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, nonprofit, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-144 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The warehouse tried offering monthly lifting-safety and ergonomic training. Back-injury claims fell by 20% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The training room has a ceiling-mounted projector. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** New lifting equipment arrived that quarter; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, workplace safety, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-145 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The city sanitation office tried placing compost bins in apartment lobbies. Landfill waste from participating buildings fell by 17% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The lobby compost bins have foot pedals. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. Trash pickup schedules also changed; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, environment, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-146 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The app maker tried making new user profiles private by default. Publicly visible profiles fell by 48% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The privacy screen uses a shield icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The app also deleted inactive accounts; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, technology, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-147 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The clinic tried reserving same-day appointment slots. Patient no-show rates fell by 13% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The appointment cards are white. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The clinic also began reminder calls; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, health, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-148 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The airline tried boarding passengers by seat zone. Average boarding time fell by 9% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The gate signs are backlit. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The airline also reduced carry-on size limits; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, travel, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-149 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The landlord tried launching an online apartment repair portal. Unresolved repair requests fell by 26% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The landlord hired two additional repair technicians; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The repair portal uses a house logo. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, housing, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-150 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The cafeteria tried moving fruit bowls to the front of the cafeteria line. Fruit purchases rose by 23% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. A fruit discount started that week; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The fruit bowls are ceramic. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, food, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-151 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The call center tried giving support agents weekly script coaching. Customer complaint rates fell by 18% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The coaching slides use blue headers. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The call queue was also shortened; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, customer support, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-152 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The water utility tried sending automatic household water-leak alerts. Average household water use fell by 10% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The water-leak alert screen includes a blue droplet icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. A rainy season began during the study; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, utilities, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-153 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The police department tried sending body-camera activation reminders before patrol shifts. Missing-camera-footage reports fell by 35% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Taylor says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The department also updated supervisor reviews; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The reminder tone is two beeps. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, governance, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-154 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The election office tried offering online mail-ballot tracking. Phone calls asking ballot status fell by 42% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Morgan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The office also expanded its phone staff; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The ballot-tracking page uses county colors. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, election administration, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-155 | Level 5 | Answer D

Prompt. The tutoring app tried sending spaced-review prompts for language vocabulary. Vocabulary retention quiz scores rose by 12% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Casey says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The review prompts use a bell icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The app also changed the quiz format; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is D because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, learning, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

alternative_explanations-156 | Level 5 | Answer C

Prompt. The gym tried offering a beginner gym orientation. New-member cancellations fell by 19% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Jordan says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The orientation mats are black. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**B.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice
C. The gym also discounted annual plans; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is C because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, fitness, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

C feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-157 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The insurer tried sending weekly safe-driving feedback. Reported minor crashes fell by 8% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Riley says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** Fuel prices changed driving patterns that month; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The feedback dashboard uses star ratings. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, insurance, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

alternative_explanations-158 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The newsroom tried placing corrections at the top of articles. Reader trust ratings rose by 7% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Maya says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The newsroom also hired a public editor; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The correction box has a gray border. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice
C. The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice	**D.** The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, media, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

alternative_explanations-159 | Level 5 | Answer A

Prompt. The farmers market tried requiring clearer price signs at vendor stalls. Price disputes fell by 28% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Sam says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The market also added a weekend help desk; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct	**B.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice
C. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**D.** The stall price signs are laminated. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is A because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, local commerce, d5

A feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

B feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

alternative_explanations-160 | Level 5 | Answer B

Prompt. The hotel tried sending quiet-hours text reminders to hotel guests. Noise complaints from guest rooms fell by 30% in the four weeks after the plan began compared with the four weeks before it. Avery says, "The plan caused the change." Which other explanation also fits the facts?

A. The plan was discussed before the result changed, which gives timing rather than another possible cause during that period or separate the plan from other changes. choice	**B.** The hotel also changed room assignments; that happened during the same period and could also explain the change. correct
C. The quiet-hours text reminder uses a small moon icon. That visible detail is part of the scene, not another explanation of the change. choice	**D.** The result is reported as a percentage, which describes what happened but not why it happened. choice

Core explanation. A good alternative explanation fits the same facts without assuming the first cause is right.

Process commentary. To uncover the answer, keep the observed result fixed and test which option gives another plausible cause. The correct choice is B because it fits the facts without assuming the original explanation is the only one.

Tags: alternative_explanations, alternatives, hospitality, d5

A feedback (Distractor): Not quite. Timing tells when things happened, but it does not give a separate cause that could explain the change.

B feedback (Correct): Correct. This explanation fits the same facts without assuming the proposed plan caused the result.

C feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A scene detail may be true, but it does not explain why the result changed.

D feedback (Distractor): Not quite. A percentage describes the result, but it does not give another explanation for why the result happened.